MODERN INDIA I · DAY 5 OF 6 · TEST ON 31 OCT 2026

Uprisings till 1857 and the Revolt of 1857

When, where, why, by whom, key people, key events for every revolt · India map · mind map

About 22 questions today are on the earlier revolts and peasant movements, and about 28 are on 1857 and what followed. Every revolt below has the same card: **When, Where, Why, By whom, Key people, Key events, Result, Exam hook**. The numbered circle on a card is its place on the India map.

HOW TO USE THIS NOTE (ABOUT 60 MINUTES)

1. **5 min:** mind map and map. See the four families and where they sit.
2. **35 min:** read the cards cluster by cluster, then do each five-question recall box.
3. **10 min:** the 1857 causes, course, failure and aftermath tables.
4. **5 min:** last-minute sheet. Then start the 50 questions.

1. The big picture before 1857

Between 1763 and 1857 there were hundreds of small revolts. They fall into three families, plus the great Revolt of 1857. Learn the family first, then the names.

Family	Who rose	Against whom	Examples
Civil rebellions	Dispossessed rajas, poligars, zamindars, soldiers, displaced peasants	The Company's rule: loss of power, land and service	Sanyasi, Chuar, Poligar, Paika, Kittur, Vellore

Family	Who rose	Against whom	Examples
Tribal uprisings	Adivasis (Kol, Santhal, Munda, Khasi)	Outsiders and the land, forest and revenue laws that favoured them	Kol, Santhal Hul, Munda Ulgulan
Peasant movements	Cultivators	Zamindars, moneylenders, indigo planters	Indigo, Pabna, Deccan, Mappila
Revolt of 1857	Sepoys, then rajas, taluqdars, peasants, artisans	Company rule	Meerut, Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi

FEATURES COMMON TO THE EARLY REVOLTS (UPSC ASKS THIS)

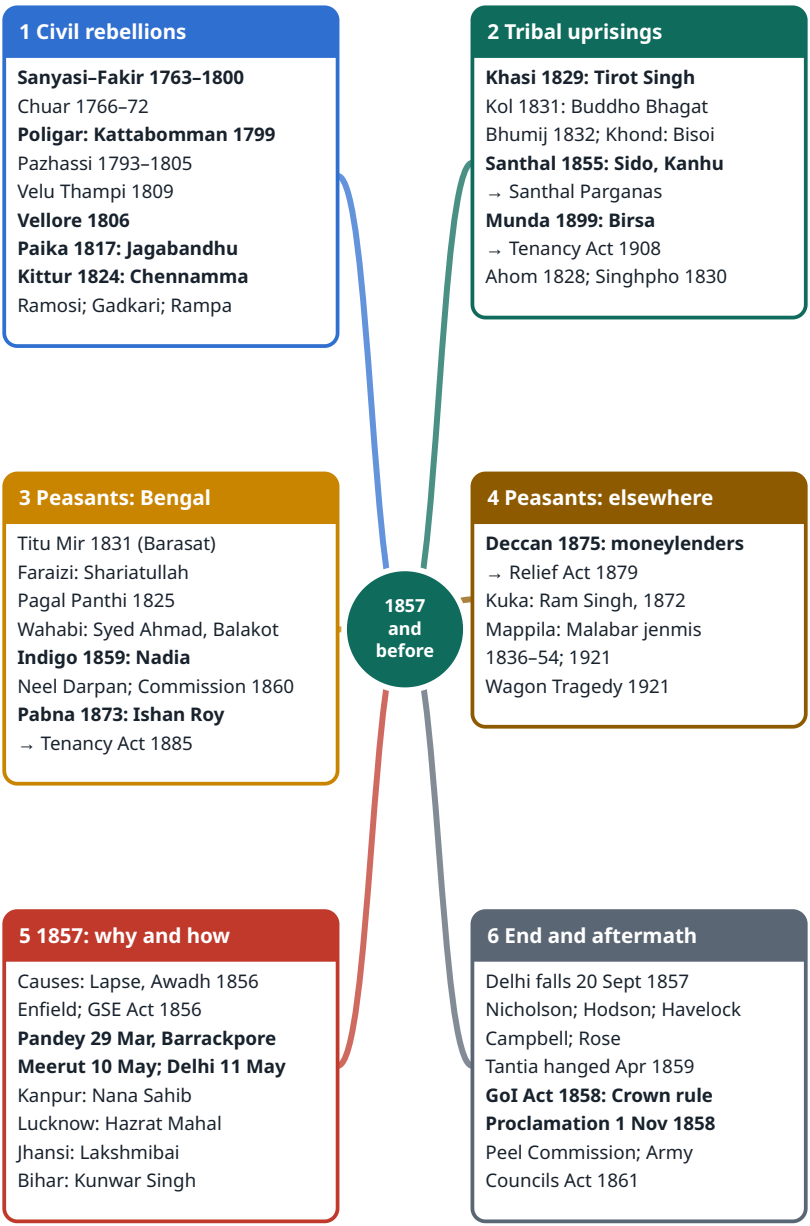
- Resentment against **outsiders** (*dikus*) who took tribal or peasant land.
- **Local**, not all-India. No common plan, no modern ideas, old weapons (bows, swords, clubs).
- Led by **local chiefs, village headmen or religious figures**, not the Western-educated middle class.
- Religion was often the language of protest, but the cause was usually land, rent or debt.
- Suppressed with force, but they often forced a **legal remedy** (a new district, a tenancy act).

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER 12 THINGS

1. Almost every tribal and peasant revolt was against **outsiders (dikus)** who took land: moneylenders, traders, revenue officials, zamindars.
2. **Santhal Hul** 1855–56: Sido and Kanhu, Rajmahal hills. Result: **Santhal Parganas** district.
3. **Munda Ulgulan** 1899–1900: **Birsa Munda**, Chotanagpur. He died of cholera in Ranchi jail (not hanged). Result: **Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908**.
4. **Kol** 1831–32 (Buddho Bhagat), **Khasi** 1829 (Tirot Singh), **Paika** 1817 (Jagabandhu, Odisha).
5. **Pabna 1873** was against zamindars, not the British. **Deccan 1875** was against moneylenders (no zamindars there). **Indigo 1859–60** began in Nadia.
6. **Titu Mir** (Barasat, bamboo fort), **Faraizi** (Shariatullah, Dudu Miyan), **Wahabi** (Syed Ahmad, Balakot 1831), **Kuka** (Ram Singh).
7. 1857: immediate cause = **Enfield rifle** cartridge (1856). Mangal Pandey, 34th BNI, Barrackpore, **29 March**. Meerut **10 May**, Delhi **11 May**.
8. Awadh was annexed in 1856 for **misrule**, not by Lapse. Many Bengal Army sepoys came from Awadh.
9. Leaders: Nana Sahib (Kanpur), Hazrat Mahal (Lucknow), Kunwar Singh (Jagdishpur), Khan Bahadur Khan (Bareilly), Lakshmibai (Jhansi), Bakht Khan (Delhi).
10. Captured Bahadur Shah: **Hodson**; exiled to Rangoon, died 1862. Tantia Tope betrayed by **Man Singh of Narwar**, hanged April 1859.
11. Failure: no common plan; Sikhs, Gurkhas, Madras Army, Nizam, Scindia stayed with the British.
12. After: **GoI Act 1858**, **Queen's Proclamation (1 Nov 1858)**, army reorganised, Councils Act 1861. No elected legislatures promised.

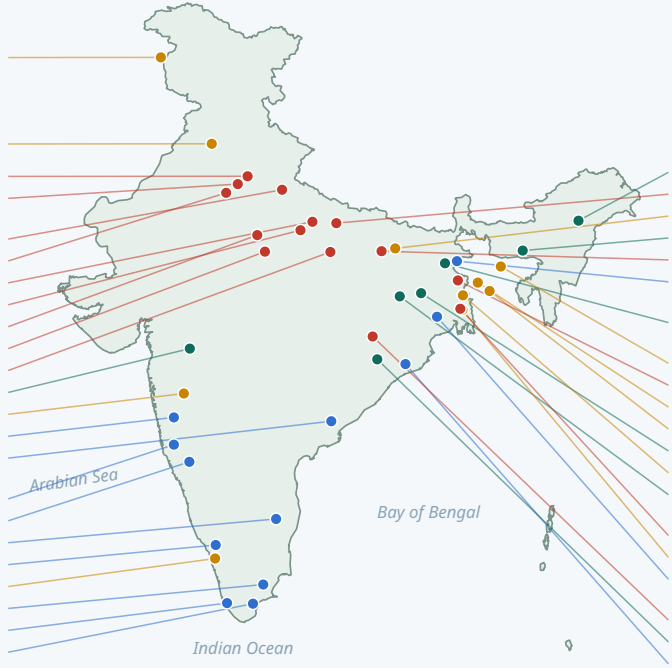
2. Mind map

Read it in 2 minutes. Six boxes cover everything in today's test.



3. India map: place, revolt or movement, and year

Civil rebellion · Tribal · Peasant · 1857



26 **Balakot:** Syed Ahmad killed 1831

28 **Ludhiana and Malerkotla:** Kuka 1872

32 **Meerut:** Revolt begins, 10 May 1857
33 **Delhi:** Bahadur Shah II; falls 20 Sept 1857
35 **Bareilly:** Khan Bahadur Khan 1857
34 **Rewari:** Rao Tula Ram 1857
37 **Lucknow:** Hazrat Mahal 1857–58
36 **Kanpur:** Nana Sahib 1857
41 **Gwalior:** Lakshmibai dies 17 Jun 1858
40 **Jhansi:** Lakshmibai; Rose, Apr 1858
39 **Allahabad:** Liaqat Ali; Neill 1857
19 **Khandesh:** Bhil risings from 1817
27 **Poona and Ahmednagar:** Deccan riots 1875
10 **Satara:** Ramosi 1822, 1825–26
12 **Rampa (Godavari hills):** Rampa 1879; Alluri Sitarama Raju 1922–24
11 **Kolhapur and Sawantwadi:** Gadkari 1844
9 **Kittur (Belgaum):** Rani Chennamma 1824
8 **Vellore:** Vellore Mutiny 1806
6 **Wayanad:** Pazhassi Raja 1793–1805
29 **Malabar:** Mappila 1836–54, 1921
5 **Sivaganga:** Marudu brothers 1801
7 **Kundara (Travancore):** Velu Thampi 1808–09
4 **Panchalankurichi:** Kattabomman 1799

14 **Upper Assam:** Ahom 1828; Singhpho 1830
38 **Faizabad:** Maulvi Ahmadullah 1857–58
25 **Patna:** Wahabi centre
13 **Khasi Hills:** Tirot Singh 1829–33
42 **Jagdishpur (Arrah):** Kunwar Singh 1857–58
1 **North Bengal and Bihar:** Sanyasi–Fakir 1763–1800
17 **Rajmahal hills (Damin-i-Koh):** Santhal Hul 1855–56
24 **Mymensingh:** Pagal Panthi 1825–35
30 **Berhampore:** 19th BNI refuses, 26 Feb 1857
22 **Pabna:** Pabna League 1873
23 **Faridpur:** Faraizi from 1818
16 **Manbhum:** Bhumij 1832–33
21 **Nadia:** Indigo revolt 1859–60
15 **Chotanagpur (Ranchi):** Kol 1831–32; Munda Ulgulan 1899–1900
31 **Barrackpore:** Mangal Pandey, 29 Mar 1857
20 **Barasat (24 Parganas):** Titu Mir 1831
2 **Midnapore and Bankura:** Chuar 1766–72, 1795–1800
43 **Sambalpur:** Surendra Sai 1857
18 **Kandhamal (Odisha):** Khond 1840s–55
3 **Khurda (Odisha):** Paika revolt 1817

READ THE MAP LIKE THIS

- **East (Bengal, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha):** Sanyasi, Chuar, Santhal, Kol, Munda, Paika, Khond, Titu Mir, Indigo, Pabna. Land and revenue under the Permanent Settlement.
- **North and Gangetic plain:** 1857 centres: Meerut, Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi, Bareilly, Jagdishpur.
- **West and Deccan:** Kittur, Ramosi, Gadkari, Bhil, Deccan riots. Ryotwari areas, moneylenders.
- **South:** Poligars, Vellore, Pazhassi, Velu Thampi, Mappilas.

4. Cluster 1: Civil rebellions and early revolts

Sanyasi and Fakir rebellion

1763–1800 1

WHEN	1763 to about 1800.
WHERE	North Bengal and Bihar.
WHY	After the Company took Diwani, restrictions on pilgrimage, heavy revenue and the **1770 famine** hit wandering Hindu ascetics (sanyasis) and Muslim fakirs.
BY WHOM	Sanyasi and fakir bands.
KEY PEOPLE	Majnu Shah, Chirag Ali, Bhawani Pathak, Devi Chaudhurani.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Bands of Hindu sanyasis and Muslim fakirs raided company granaries and officials; aims were relief from pilgrim-tax limits and famine misery.
KEY EVENTS	• Raids on Company treasuries and revenue offices; guerrilla war across Bengal and Bihar. • **Anandamath** (Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, 1882) is a novel built on this rebellion and gave India "Vande Mataram".
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Bankim's *Anandamath* (1882) is based on it; leaders: Majnu Shah, Bhawani Pathak, Devi Chaudhurani.
RESULT	Put down by the 1800s; the Company tightened control of pilgrim movement.

LIMITS	• Put down by Warren Hastings' forces by about 1800; no unified goal or leadership.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Sanyasi rebellion (Bengal, 1763–1800) vs Chuar (Midnapore) vs Santhal.
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in lists on *Anandamath* and early revolts; no recent direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Sanyasi = Bengal, famine of 1770; Anandamath.

Chuar rebellion

1766–72, 1795–1800 2

WHEN	1766–72 and again 1795–1800.
WHERE	Midnapore and Bankura, Bengal.
WHY	Hungry peasants and displaced soldiers (paiks) rose against revenue demands and loss of land after the Company's takeover.
BY WHOM	Local chiefs and peasants.
KEY PEOPLE	Durjan Singh, Rani Shiromani.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Tribal Chuars of Midnapore, Bankura rose against land revenue demands, famine and loss of land.
KEY EVENTS	• Raids on revenue officers and zamindars' men.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Leaders: Durjan Singh, Jagannath Dhal; ended after Regulation of the 1790s.
RESULT	Suppressed with force.
LIMITS	• Suppressed by force; local, with no outside support.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Chuar (Midnapore) is not the Kol (Chotanagpur).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Chuar = Midnapore, Bankura.

Poligar wars and Kattabomman

1799–1805 4 5

WHEN	1799–1805.
WHERE	Tirunelveli and Madurai: Panchalankurichi and Sivaganga (Tamil country).
WHY	Poligars (military chiefs with local revenue rights) resented the Company's demand for tribute and the loss of their power.
BY WHOM	**Veerapandya Kattabomman**; the Marudu brothers; Dheeran Chinnamalai (Kongu region).
KEY PEOPLE	Kattabomman, Oomaithurai (his brother), the Marudu brothers (Periya and Chinna Marudu), Dheeran Chinnamalai.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Poligars (palayakkarars) refused to pay tribute to the Nawab and the Company; Kattabomman was hanged in 1799.
KEY EVENTS	• **1799** Kattabomman refused tribute; his fort at Panchalankurichi fell and he was hanged at Kayattar on **16 Oct 1799**. • **1801** The Marudu brothers rose in Sivaganga; they were hanged. • 1805 The Poligar wars ended.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• South Indian Confederacy of Marudu brothers, Gopala Nayak and Kerala Varma; Second Poligar War 1801.
RESULT	The Company ended the poligari system and took direct control of the Tamil south.
LIMITS	• Poligar system ended; the Madras Presidency tightened its grip.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Veerapandiya Kattabomman (Panchalankurichi) vs Marudu brothers (Sivaganga).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in Tamil Nadu-flavoured questions and in matching lists.
EXAM HOOK	Kattabomman hanged 1799; Panchalankurichi.

Pazhassi Raja

1793–1805 6

WHEN	1793–1805.
WHERE	Kottayam (north Malabar) and Wayanad.
WHY	The Company raised the revenue demand and tried to remove his rights.
BY WHOM	**Pazhassi Raja** (Kerala Varma).
KEY PEOPLE	Pazhassi Raja, Kaitheri Ambu, Edachena Kungan.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Resistance in Wayanad by guerrilla methods against the Company over pepper control and tax.
KEY EVENTS	• Guerrilla war in the Wayanad forests; he was killed in **1805**.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Cotiote War, 1793–1805; Kurichya tribals backed him.
RESULT	The Company took control of Malabar.
LIMITS	• Killed in 1805; Kerala came fully under the Company.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Pazhassi (Kottayam) vs Velu Thampi (Travancore).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Pazhassi = guerrilla till 1805.

Velu Thampi

1808–09 7

WHEN	1808–09.
WHERE	Travancore.
WHY	The burden of the Subsidiary Alliance and the Resident's interference.
BY WHOM	**Velu Thampi Dalawa**, **Dewan of Travancore**.
KEY PEOPLE	Velu Thampi, Paliath Achan (Cochin minister).

AIMS AND METHODS	• Dewan of Travancore; Kundara Proclamation of 1809 called for a rising against the British and the subsidiary system.
KEY EVENTS	• **Jan 1809** Kundara Proclamation calling people to rise; he died by suicide in 1809 when defeated.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Colonel Macaulay was the Resident.
RESULT	Travancore came under tighter British control.
LIMITS	• Defeated; Velu Thampi killed himself in 1809.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Velu Thampi (Travancore, 1809) vs Pazhassi (Malabar, 1793–1805).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Velu Thampi was Dewan of **Travancore**, not Mysore.

Vellore Mutiny

10 July 1806 8

WHEN	**10 July 1806**.
WHERE	Vellore (Madras Army).
WHY	New dress and turban rules, a ban on caste marks and earrings. Tipu's family was held at Vellore.
BY WHOM	Sepoys of the Madras Army.
KEY PEOPLE	Sepoys; Tipu's sons (rebels hoisted Tipu's flag).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Sepoys objected to new turban, caste marks and earrings; the Mysore royal family was nearby.
KEY EVENTS	• Killed European officers; relief column from Arcot crushed the rising.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Orders by Commander-in-Chief Sir John Craddock; Governor Bentinck recalled.

RESULT	The Company withdrew the order and replaced the officers. The first big sign that the army could revolt, 51 years before 1857.
LIMITS	• Suppressed within a day by Col. Gillespie; the reforms were withdrawn.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Vellore 1806 (dress code) vs Barrackpore 1824 vs 1857 (cartridges).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in "first sepoy mutiny" lists.
EXAM HOOK	Vellore 1806 = Madras Army, Governor-General Barlow.

Paika revolt (Khurda)

1817 3

WHEN	**1817**.
WHERE	Khurda, Odisha.
WHY	The Company took Odisha in 1803. The paikas (peasant militia) lost their rent-free service lands. Salt prices rose, and cowries were replaced by silver coin.
BY WHOM	**Bakshi Jagabandhu** (Bidyadhar), commander of the Raja of Khurda.
KEY PEOPLE	Jagabandhu; Raja of Khurda.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Paika militia lost rent-free lands after the 1803 conquest of Odisha; salt price and the new currency angered people.
KEY EVENTS	• Rebels burned government buildings and attacked police posts.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Led by Bakshi Jagabandhu; 1817 rising.
RESULT	Crushed in a year; Jagabandhu surrendered in 1825.
LIMITS	• Put down by 1818; Jagabandhu surrendered in 1825.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Paika (Odisha, 1817) vs Kittur (Karnataka, 1824).
UPSC ASKED	• Odisha's government called it the "first war of independence" in recent news.

EXAM HOOK	Jagabandhu = Paika, Odisha.

Kittur revolt

1824 [9]

WHEN	**1824**.
WHERE	Kittur, Belgaum district, Karnataka.
WHY	The Company refused to accept the adopted heir of the ruler, the early form of the Doctrine of Lapse.
BY WHOM	**Rani Chennamma**; later her aide Rayanna.
KEY PEOPLE	Rani Chennamma, Rayanna (Sangolli).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Rani Chennamma refused to accept the Doctrine of Lapse-type adoption rule.
KEY EVENTS	• Collector Thackeray was killed in battle.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Sangolli Rayanna was her commander.
RESULT	Chennamma was captured and died in jail in 1829; Rayanna was hanged in 1831.
LIMITS	• Captured in 1824; died in jail 1829; Rayanna hanged in 1831.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Kittur Chennamma (1824) vs Rani Lakshmibai (1857).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in women-fighters lists.
EXAM HOOK	Kittur 1824 is before Dalhousie's Lapse, but for the same reason.

Ramosi, Gadkari and Rampa revolts

1822–1924 [10] [11] [12]

WHEN	Ramosi 1822 and 1825–26; Gadkari 1844; Rampa 1879 and 1922–24.
WHERE	Satara; Kolhapur and Sawantwadi; Godavari hills.

WHY	High revenue, famine, dismissal of hereditary garrison servants, and forest laws and forced labour (begar).
BY WHOM	Ramosi: **Chittur Singh** and Umaji Naik. Gadkari: Phond Sawant. Rampa: **Alluri Sitarama Raju** (1922).
KEY PEOPLE	Chittur Singh, Umaji Naik, Phond Sawant, Alluri Sitarama Raju.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Ramosis rose after Peshwa rule ended and over loss of jobs; Gadkaris of Kolhapur resisted dismissal of militia; Rampa rebels faced a forest-lease crisis.
KEY EVENTS	• Ramosis rose in 1822 and 1825–26 under Umaji Naik. • 1844 Gadkari rising in Kolhapur. • 1922–24 Alluri's guerrilla war in the Rampa hills.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Leaders: Chittur Singh, Umaji Naik, Alluri Sitarama Raju (1922 Rampa).
RESULT	Alluri was shot in 1924; the rebellions pressed the government to reform forest and revenue rules.
LIMITS	• Put down by force; Rampa 1922–24 ended with Sitarama Raju's death.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Rampa rebellion (1879) vs Rampa rebellion (1922).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Alluri Sitarama Raju = Rampa 1922.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 1

1. When was Kattabomman hanged? (1799)
2. Whose Dewan was Velu Thampi? (Travancore)
3. Which mutiny of 1806 anticipated 1857? (Vellore)
4. Who led the Paika revolt? (Jagabandhu)
5. Which revolt came before Dalhousie's Lapse but for the same cause? (Kittur, 1824)

5. Cluster 2: Tribal uprisings

Khasi uprising — 1829–33 (13)

WHEN	1829–33.
WHERE	Khasi and Garo hills, Meghalaya.
WHY	The British planned a **military road** from the Brahmaputra valley to Sylhet through Khasi hills, bringing outside labour.
BY WHOM	**Tirot Singh**, Khasi chief.
KEY PEOPLE	Tirot Singh; Garos joined.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Nongkhlaw chief Tirot Singh resisted the Company's road to Sylhet through Khasi hills.
KEY EVENTS	• 1829 Attacks on British posts; guerrilla war in the hills.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Anglo-Khasi War, 1829–33.
RESULT	Suppressed in 1833; Tirot Singh captured.
LIMITS	• Tirot Singh captured; hills lost to the British.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Khasi (Meghalaya) vs Ahom (Assam).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Khasi = Tirot Singh, road to Sylhet.

Ahom and Singhpho revolts — 1828 and 1830 (14)

WHEN	1828 and 1830.
WHERE	Assam.
WHY	The British did not leave Assam after the First Burmese War (Yandabo, 1826) as they had promised.
BY WHOM	Ahom nobles under **Gomdhar Konwar**; Singhpho under Nirang Phidu.

KEY PEOPLE	Gomdhar Konwar, Nirang Phidu, Maniram Dewan (hanged 1858).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Ahom nobles feared annexation after the Burma war (1826); Singphos rose in 1830.
KEY EVENTS	• 1828 Ahom plot at Jorhat.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Gomdhar Konwar and Piyali Phukan led the Ahom rising of 1828.
RESULT	Assam was brought under direct rule.
LIMITS	• Crushed by 1830s; Upper Assam given to Purandar Singha.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Ahom vs Khasi vs Singpho.
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Ahom = Assam after Yandabo.

Kol revolt

1831–32 15

WHEN	1831–32.
WHERE	Chotanagpur and Singhbhum.
WHY	Land passed to outside farmers and moneylenders; high revenue and the forest laws.
BY WHOM	Kol tribals led by **Buddho Bhagat**.
KEY PEOPLE	Buddho Bhagat, Joa Bhagat.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Kols, Mundas and Oraons resisted outsiders (dikus) taking land.
KEY EVENTS	• Rebels attacked outsiders' houses; troops came from Calcutta and Banaras.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• 1831–32; Buddhu Bhagat; Chotanagpur.

RESULT	Crushed; the Company created the South-West Frontier Agency (1833) to rule the area directly.
LIMITS	• Put down; Regulation XIII of 1833 created the South West Frontier Agency.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Kol (1831) vs Santhal (1855) vs Munda (1899).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in tribal revolt lists.
EXAM HOOK	Kol = Chotanagpur; Buddho Bhagat.

Bhumij and Khond revolts

1832–33; 1840s–55 16 18

WHEN	Bhumij 1832–33; Khond 1837–56.
WHERE	Manbhum; Odisha hills (Kandhamal).
WHY	Bhumij: loss of headmen's rights and land revenue. Khond: opposition to the ban on human sacrifice (meriah), new taxes and moneylenders.
BY WHOM	Bhumij: **Ganga Narayan Singh**. Khond: **Chakra Bisoi**.
KEY PEOPLE	Ganga Narayan Singh, Chakra Bisoi.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Bhumij of Manbhum (1832–33) rose against the Company's revenue; Khond (1846 and 1855) rose against human-sacrifice laws and money-lenders.
KEY EVENTS	• Bhumij rising at Barabhum; Khond rising lasted into the 1850s.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Ganga Narayan (Bhumij), Chakra Bisoyi (Khond).
RESULT	Both crushed.
LIMITS	• Put down; Meriah sacrifice laws.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Bhumij (Bengal) vs Khond (Odisha).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.

EXAM HOOK	Chakra Bisoi = Khond.

Santhal Hul

1855–56 17

WHEN	**30 June 1855** (about 10,000 gathered); crushed by 1856.
WHERE	Rajmahal hills (Damin-i-Koh), Bengal and Bihar.
WHY	Moneylenders, zamindars and officials who protected them; interest rates of up to 500%; loss of land.
BY WHOM	**Sido and Kanhu** (with brothers Chand and Bhairav).
KEY PEOPLE	Sido, Kanhu, Chand, Bhairav.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Santhals fought moneylenders (*mahajans*), zamindars and the Company over land and debt.
KEY EVENTS	• **June 1855** Santhals gathered at Bhognadihi and declared their own rule. • Attacked moneylenders and police; martial law declared; Sido and Kanhu were captured and hanged.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Leaders: Sido and Kanhu (1855–56) with Chand and Bhairav; Damin-i-Koh area.
RESULT	The British created the **Santhal Parganas** district and barred transfer of Santhal land to non-Santhals (UPSC 2018).
LIMITS	• Crushed; Santhal Parganas Act formed as a separate district in 1855–56.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Santhal Hul (1855) vs Kol (1831) vs Munda Ulgulan (1899).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in tribal revolt lists in Prelims.
EXAM HOOK	Sido and Kanhu = Santhal. Birsa = Munda. Do not swap them.

Munda Ulgulan (Birsa Munda)

1899–1900 15

WHEN	**1899–1900** (Dec 1899 to Jan 1900).
WHERE	Chotanagpur plateau; Ranchi and Khunti.

WHY	The collapse of the **khuntkatti** (joint tribal ownership) system under zamindars, traders and moneylenders; forced labour (*beth begari*).
BY WHOM	**Birsa Munda** (born 1875), who declared a new faith and an end to the dikus' rule.
KEY PEOPLE	Birsa Munda; his followers (Birsaites).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Birsa preached one God (*Singbonga*) and attacked the khuntkatti land system change.
KEY EVENTS	• **1895** First arrest of Birsa; **1899** Armed rising (Ulgulan = great tumult). • **1900** Captured; died of **cholera** in Ranchi jail, June 1900 (not hanged).
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Birsa's Ulgulan 1899–1900; the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act, 1908 followed.
RESULT	**Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908** protected tribal land rights.
LIMITS	• Birsa died in jail in 1900; the movement gave the Tenancy Act.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Munda (1899) vs Santhal (1855) vs Kol (1831).
UPSC ASKED	• **2014:** Birsa Munda appeared in a tribal movements question. • Frequent in Tribal-movement matching.
EXAM HOOK	Ulgulan = Birsa Munda (UPSC 2020). Not hanged.

Bhil risings

from 1817 19

WHEN	From 1817, with later risings.
WHERE	Khandesh and western India.
WHY	Loss of land and forest rights, and the Company's revenue demand after Maratha rule ended.
BY WHOM	Bhil chiefs.
KEY PEOPLE	Local Bhil leaders.

AIMS AND METHODS	• Bhils of Khandesh and Rajasthan rose against Company rule and loss of land.
KEY EVENTS	• The Bhils of Khandesh rose against the Company after 1817.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Govind Guru's Sampsabha (1883) and the Banswara hills 1913 (Mangarh).
RESULT	The Company recruited Bhil Corps to control the area.
LIMITS	• Put down.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Bhil (West India) vs Kol (East).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Bhil = Khandesh.

ORDER TO REMEMBER

Khasi (1829) → Kol (1831) → Bhumij (1832) → Santhal (1855) → Indigo (1859) → Munda (1899). Test question: Kol, Santhal, Indigo, Munda is the right order.

TRAPS UPSC LOVES

- Sido–Kanhu = Santhal. Birsa = Munda.
- Santhal = Rajmahal hills. Munda and Kol = Chotanagpur.
- Birsa was **not** hanged.
- Tribal leaders were not educated or middle class, and no one asked for a constitution.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 2

1. Who led the Santhal Hul? (Sido and Kanhu)
2. What district came out of it? (Santhal Parganas)
3. Which Act followed the Munda rising? (Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908)
4. How did Birsa die? (Cholera, Ranchi jail)
5. Which revolt was against a military road to Sylhet? (Khasi)

6. Cluster 3: Peasant and religious-agrarian movements

Titu Mir	1830–31 20
WHEN	1830–31.
WHERE	Barasat, 24 Parganas, Bengal.
WHY	Poor Muslim peasants faced Hindu zamindars who taxed beards and mosques, and indigo planters.
BY WHOM	**Mir Nithar Ali (Titu Mir)**, follower of Syed Ahmad Barelvi.
KEY PEOPLE	Titu Mir.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Peasants resisted zamindars and indigo planters; Titu Mir used religious reform to organise.
KEY EVENTS	• Built a **bamboo fort at Narkelbaria**; killed by British troops in 1831.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Bansher Kella (bamboo fort); Narkelberia village.
RESULT	Often called the first armed peasant revolt; crushed.
LIMITS	• Titu Mir killed by 1831 forces.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Titu Mir vs Dudu Miyan.
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.

EXAM HOOK	Titu Mir = Barasat, bamboo fort.

Faraizi movement

from 1818 23

WHEN	From 1818 into the 1860s.
WHERE	Faridpur, East Bengal.
WHY	Stress on the **faraiz** (obligatory duties of Islam). It later turned against zamindars' illegal cesses.
BY WHOM	**Haji Shariatullah**; his son **Dudu Miyan**.
KEY PEOPLE	Shariatullah, Dudu Miyan.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Followers of the compulsory duties (*faraiz*) in Islam; against taxes on beards and illegal cesses.
KEY EVENTS	• Dudu Miyan gave it an agrarian edge: "land belongs to God".
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Haji Shariatullah founded it (1818); Dudu Miyan.
RESULT	Active against zamindars and indigo planters until about 1860.
LIMITS	• Declined after 1860.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Faraizi (Faridpur, East Bengal) vs Wahabi (Patna).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Faraizi = Shariatullah, not Titu Mir.

Pagal Panthi

1825–35 24

WHEN	1825–35.
WHERE	Mymensingh, Bengal.
WHY	Garo and Hajong peasants resented zamindars' oppression.
BY WHOM	Karam Shah, then his son **Tipu**.

KEY PEOPLE	Karam Shah, Tipu.
AIMS AND METHODS	• A mix of religion and peasants' rising against zamindars; Karam Shah and his son Tipu.
KEY EVENTS	• Armed resistance to zamindars' collectors.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Mymensingh area, 1825–27.
RESULT	Suppressed.
LIMITS	• Tipu rose against zamindars; the revolt was suppressed.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Pagal Panthi (Mymensingh) vs Faraizi.
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Pagal Panthi = Mymensingh.

Wahabi movement

1820s–1870s 25 26

WHEN	1820s to the 1870s.
WHERE	Patna (centre), Sittana; Balakot (1831).
WHY	Revival of pure Islam; revival of *Dar-ul-Islam* against Sikh and British rule.
BY WHOM	**Syed Ahmad of Rae Bareli**, inspired by Shah Waliullah.
KEY PEOPLE	Syed Ahmad, Shah Waliullah (inspiration), Titu Mir (follower).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Revive pure Islam; war against Sikh and later British rule.
KEY EVENTS	• **1831** Syed Ahmad was killed at **Balakot** fighting the Sikhs. • 1860s–70s Wahabi trials in Ambala and Patna.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Syed Ahmad of Rae Bareli; Sittana; Ambala trial 1864; Patna as centre.
RESULT	The movement was put down in the 1860s–70s.

LIMITS	• Defeated in the Ambala and other trials.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Wahabi (Syed Ahmad Rae Bareli) vs Aligarh (Syed Ahmad Khan).
UPSC ASKED	• Wahabi vs Aligarh swaps are frequent in options.
EXAM HOOK	Faridpur belongs to the Faraizis, not Wahabis.

Indigo revolt

1859–60 21

WHEN	**1859–60**; Commission 1860.
WHERE	Nadia, Bengal; spread to Jessore, Pabna.
WHY	European planters forced peasants to grow indigo under unfair advance contracts (dadan) with low prices.
BY WHOM	Peasants led by **Digambar and Bishnucharan Biswas**.
KEY PEOPLE	Digambar Biswas, Bishnucharan Biswas; Dinabandhu Mitra (*Neel Darpan* 1860); Harish Chandra Mukherjee (*Hindoo Patriot*); Rev. James Long (translator).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Peasants refused to grow indigo under the *tinkathia* system.
KEY EVENTS	• **1859** Peasants refused to grow indigo. • **1860** *Neel Darpan* (play). • **1860** Indigo Commission criticised the planters; the government declared ryots could not be forced to grow indigo.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• *Neel Darpan* by Dinabandhu Mitra (1860); Harish Chandra Mukherjee of *Hindoo Patriot*; Digambar and Bishnu Biswas.
RESULT	Indigo cultivation died out later because of **synthetic dyes** (UPSC 2020).
LIMITS	• Indigo Commission 1860 (Seton-Karr) and the Act of 1862.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Bengal indigo 1859–60 vs Champaran 1917.
UPSC ASKED	• **2018:** Neel Darpan appears in an order-of-events question.

EXAM HOOK	Indigo began in Nadia, not Pabna.

Pabna Agrarian League

1873 22

WHEN	**1873**.
WHERE	Pabna, East Bengal.
WHY	Zamindars raised rents and imposed illegal cesses.
BY WHOM	**Ishan Chandra Roy**; Shambhu Pal; Kesab Chandra Roy.
KEY PEOPLE	Ishan Chandra Roy.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Peasants of Pabna resisted rent enhancement; used legal means.
KEY EVENTS	• Tenants formed leagues; refused to pay enhanced rent; fought in the courts.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Ishan Chandra Roy; Keshab Chandra Roy.
RESULT	Led to the **Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885**.
LIMITS	• Bengal Tenancy Act 1885.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Pabna 1873 (legal) vs Deccan 1875 (riots).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Pabna was **not anti-British**: they called themselves the Queen's ryots.

Deccan riots

1875 27

WHEN	**1875**; Relief Act 1879.
WHERE	Poona and Ahmednagar, Maharashtra.
WHY	Ryotwari area, so **no zamindars**; the target was **moneylenders** (sahukars). Cotton prices crashed after the American Civil War; revenue was raised in 1867.
BY WHOM	Peasants (Kunbis), no single leader.

KEY PEOPLE	Local peasants.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Peasants attacked moneylender houses and burned bonds.
KEY EVENTS	• Bonds and decrees were burnt; moneylenders' shops looted.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Supa (1875); Deccan Agriculturists Relief Act 1879.
RESULT	**Deccan Agriculturists Relief Act, 1879**.
LIMITS	• Led to the Relief Act of 1879.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Deccan 1875 vs Pabna 1873.
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Deccan = moneylenders, not zamindars.

Kuka (Namdhari) revolt

1872 28

WHEN	1872.
WHERE	Ludhiana and Malerkotla, Punjab.
WHY	A Sikh sect turned political: boycott of British courts, schools, post and goods.
BY WHOM	**Baba Ram Singh**, Bhaini Sahib.
KEY PEOPLE	Ram Singh.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Reformist Sikh sect that turned against the British.
KEY EVENTS	• 1872 clash at Malerkotla: about 65 Kukas were blown from guns; Ram Singh was exiled to Rangoon.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Ram Singh; Malerkotla 1872.
RESULT	Crushed. Early example of non-cooperation.

LIMITS	• Sixty-five were blown from cannons.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• See Day 6 for the religious side.
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem traced.
EXAM HOOK	Kuka = Namdhari = Ram Singh.

Mappila outbreaks

1836–54; 1921 29

WHEN	1836–54 and 1921.
WHERE	Malabar (Eranad and Valluvanad, Malappuram), Kerala.
WHY	Mappila tenants had insecure tenure and paid high rent to Hindu *jenmi* landlords, backed by British courts. Religion gave the language of protest.
BY WHOM	Local Mappila leaders (1921: Ali Musliar, Variyamkunnath Kunhahammed Haji).
KEY PEOPLE	Ali Musliar, Variyamkunnath Kunhahammed Haji.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Tenants (Mappilas) rose against Hindu landlords (*jenmi*) and the British.
KEY EVENTS	• **Nov 1921 Wagon Tragedy**: prisoners suffocated in a railway wagon from Tirur to Podanur.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• 1836–1919 outbreaks; 1921 Malabar Rebellion.
RESULT	Heavy suppression; the Malabar Tenancy Act came in 1929 and 1930.
LIMITS	• Malabar Special Police; Tenancy Act in 1930.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Mappila 1921 under Khilafat vs earlier outbreaks.
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in Khilafat links.
EXAM HOOK	Mappila = Malabar; agrarian, not just religious.

WHO DID THEY HIT? (A QUICK TEST)

Movement	Main target
Titu Mir, Faraizi, Pabna	Zamindars (rents, cesses)
Indigo	European planters
Deccan riots	Moneylenders
Mappila	Jenmi landlords and the courts behind them
Kuka, Wahabi	British rule itself

UPSC HAS ASKED

- 2018: After the Santhal uprising, the government created the **Santhal Parganas** and made it illegal for a Santhal to transfer land to a non-Santhal. Both correct.
- 2020: **Ulgulan** = Birsa Munda's revolt of 1899–1900.
- 2018: *Neel Darpan* (1860) was the earliest in a chronology question.
- 2020: Indigo declined because of **synthetic dyes**, not peasant resistance.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 3

1. Pabna 1873: target? (Zamindars; not the British)
2. Who led the Faraizis? (Shariatullah, then Dudu Miyan)
3. Which Act followed the Deccan riots? (Relief Act, 1879)
4. Which play supported the indigo revolt? (*Neel Darpan*)
5. Who led the Kukas? (Baba Ram Singh)

7. Cluster 4: The Revolt of 1857

Causes

Group of causes	What happened
Political	**Doctrine of Lapse** (Dalhousie): Satara 1848, Jaitpur and Sambalpur 1849, Baghat 1850, Udaipur 1852, **Jhansi 1853**, **Nagpur 1854**. **Awadh annexed 1856 on the charge of misrule** (not by lapse; Wajid Ali Shah had an heir). Nana Sahib's pension refused (Baji Rao II's adopted son). Titles and pensions of the Nawab of Carnatic and Raja of Tanjore ended. Mughal heirs were told to leave the Red Fort.
Economic	Heavy land revenue and rigid collection. **Inam Commission (1852, Bombay)** resumed many rent-free holdings. In Awadh the **summary settlement** dispossessed taluqdars. British cloth ruined artisans. Forced cultivation of indigo.
Administrative	Corruption in the police and lower courts; expensive justice; Indians excluded from senior posts.
Social and religious	Abolition of sati, **Widow Remarriage Act 1856**, **Caste Disabilities Removal Act 1850** (a convert to Christianity could still inherit property), missionaries, English education, taxation of temple and mosque lands. People feared forced conversion.
Military	Indian sepoys got low pay and no promotion. **Batta** (foreign allowance) was withdrawn. **General Service Enlistment Act, 1856** required sepoys to serve overseas, which high-caste Hindus believed meant losing caste. **Post Office Act, 1854** withdrew free postage. Most of the Bengal Army came from Awadh and Bihar, so the annexation touched them directly.
Immediate cause	**Enfield rifle** (introduced 1856). Its cartridge had to be bitten open. Rumour said it was greased with cow fat (Hindus) and pig fat (Muslims). The old musket was Brown Bess.

TRAPS

- The Doctrine of Lapse was **Dalhousie's**, not Canning's. The Enfield cartridge came in **1856**, in Canning's term.
- Awadh = **misrule**. Jhansi, Satara, Nagpur = lapse.
- Do not mix the Revolt (1857) with the 1855–56 Santhal Hul.

Course of the revolt

- **26 Feb:** 19th Bengal Native Infantry refuses the cartridges at Berhampore; disbanded in March.
- **29 Mar: Mangal Pandey** (34th BNI) attacks officers at **Barrackpore**; hanged 8 April.
- **24 Apr – 9 May:** Troopers of the **3rd Bengal Light Cavalry** at Meerut refuse; 85 are jailed on 9 May.
- **10 May:** Sepoys break open the jail, rise at **Meerut**, and march to Delhi.
- **11 May:** They reach **Delhi**; **Bahadur Shah II** is proclaimed Emperor of Hindustan.
- **June: Nana Sahib** rises at Kanpur (assisted by Tantia Tope and Azimullah Khan). **Henry Lawrence** dies in the Lucknow siege (July).
- **July:** Bakht Khan reaches Delhi from Bareilly and commands the rebels. **Havelock** retakes Kanpur.
- **September: Nicholson** storms Delhi; the city falls on **20 Sept**. **Hodson** captures Bahadur Shah at **Humayun's Tomb** and shoots three of his sons and grandsons.
- **Nov 1857: Colin Campbell** relieves the Lucknow Residency.
- **April 1858: Hugh Rose** takes Jhansi. **17 June 1858:** Lakshmibai dies in battle near Gwalior.
- **1 Nov 1858:** Queen's Proclamation. **April 1859:** Tantia Tope hanged.

Centres: where, who rose, who crushed them

Delhi

May–Sept 1857 33 32 34

WHEN	11 May to **20 Sept 1857**.
WHERE	Delhi (and Meerut, Rewari nearby).
WHY	The Mughal emperor gave the rising a symbolic head and legitimacy.
BY WHOM	**Bahadur Shah II** (nominal head) and **Bakht Khan** (soldier from Bareilly).
KEY PEOPLE	Bahadur Shah II, Bakht Khan, Nicholson, Hodson, Archdale Wilson.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Bahadur Shah Zafar was declared emperor; sepoys from Meerut marched on 11 May 1857.
KEY EVENTS	• 10 May Meerut; 11 May Delhi. • 20 Sept Delhi falls; Hodson captures the Emperor at Humayun's Tomb. • Rao Tula Ram of Rewari fought too; escaped to Afghanistan, died 1863.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Bakht Khan led the Bareilly force; Nicholson captured Delhi in Sept 1857; Hodson captured Zafar.
RESULT	Bahadur Shah was tried, exiled to **Rangoon**, and died there in 1862. Not hanged.
LIMITS	• Delhi fell on 20 Sept 1857; the emperor was exiled to Rangoon.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Delhi (Zafar and Bakht Khan) vs Lucknow (Begum Hazrat Mahal).
UPSC ASKED	• **2014:** Delhi events matched with leaders.
EXAM HOOK	Nicholson = Delhi. Hodson = Humayun's Tomb.

Kanpur

June–July 1857 36

WHEN	June 1857 to Dec 1857.
WHERE	Kanpur.

WHY	The Company refused to continue the pension of Baji Rao II to his adopted son, Nana Sahib.
BY WHOM	**Nana Sahib** (Dhondu Pant) with Tantia Tope and Azimullah Khan.
KEY PEOPLE	Nana Sahib, Tantia Tope, Azimullah Khan, Havelock, Colin Campbell.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Nana Sahib was the leader; Tatya Tope the general.
KEY EVENTS	• June: massacre of British at Satichaura Ghat and the Bibighar. • July: Havelock retook Kanpur.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Satichaura Ghat; Bibighar.
RESULT	Nana Sahib escaped to Nepal and was never captured.
LIMITS	• Havelock recaptured Kanpur in July 1857.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Nana Sahib (Kanpur) vs Tatya Tope.
UPSC ASKED	• Leaders-and-places matching is frequent.
EXAM HOOK	Nana Sahib = Kanpur.

Lucknow

June 1857 to March 1858 37 38

WHEN	June 1857 to March 1858.
WHERE	Lucknow; Faizabad.
WHY	The Nawab was deposed in 1856; the taluqdars lost their estates.
BY WHOM	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** for her son Birjis Qadr. At Faizabad: **Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah**.
KEY PEOPLE	Hazrat Mahal, Henry Lawrence (died July 1857), Havelock, Outram, **Colin Campbell**.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Begum Hazrat Mahal ruled for her son Birjis Qadr.

KEY EVENTS	• Siege of the Lucknow Residency. • Nov 1857: Campbell relieved the Residency.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Residency siege; Henry Lawrence killed; Campbell relieved it; Awadh annexation (1856) as cause.
RESULT	Hazrat Mahal fled to Nepal. Ahmadullah Shah was killed in 1858 by the Raja of Powayan.
LIMITS	• Recaptured in March 1858.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Lucknow (Hazrat Mahal) vs Faizabad (Maulvi Ahmadullah).
UPSC ASKED	• Leaders-and-places matching is frequent.
EXAM HOOK	Hazrat Mahal = Lucknow.

Jhansi and Gwalior

1857–58 40 41

WHEN	June 1857 to June 1858.
WHERE	Jhansi and Gwalior.
WHY	Jhansi was annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse in 1853; the Rani's adopted son was refused.
BY WHOM	**Rani Lakshmibai** and **Tantia Tope**.
KEY PEOPLE	Lakshmibai, Tantia Tope, **Hugh Rose**, Man Singh of Narwar (betrayer).
AIMS AND METHODS	• Rani Lakshmibai fought for her adopted son after the Doctrine of Lapse.
KEY EVENTS	• **April 1858** Hugh Rose took Jhansi. • **17 June 1858** Lakshmibai died fighting near Gwalior.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Hugh Rose; Tatya Tope; Gwalior fort.
RESULT	Tantia Tope was betrayed by Man Singh of Narwar and hanged in **April 1859**.
LIMITS	• Rani died 17 June 1858 at Gwalior.

DO NOT CONFUSE	• Jhansi (Rani) vs Kittur (Chennamma).
UPSC ASKED	• Frequent in leader–place matching.
EXAM HOOK	Rose, not Campbell, took Jhansi.

Bihar, Bareilly and other centres

1857–58 42 35 43 39

WHEN	1857–58.
WHERE	Jagdishpur (Arrah); Bareilly; Sambalpur; Allahabad.
WHY	Local grievances: loss of estates, revenue demands and annexations.
BY WHOM	**Kunwar Singh** (Jagdishpur); **Khan Bahadur Khan** (Bareilly); **Surendra Sai** (Sambalpur); Liaqat Ali (Allahabad).
KEY PEOPLE	Kunwar Singh (in his eighties), Khan Bahadur Khan, Surendra Sai, Liaqat Ali, Colin Campbell, Colonel Neill.
AIMS AND METHODS	• Kunwar Singh led in Arrah (Bihar); Khan Bahadur Khan in Bareilly; Maulvi Ahmadullah in Faizabad.
KEY EVENTS	• Kunwar Singh died of a wound in April 1858. • Khan Bahadur Khan was captured later and executed. • Neill suppressed Allahabad and Banaras with great brutality.
LAWS, REPORTS AND WRITINGS	• Liyaqat Ali (Allahabad); Kunwar Singh died in April 1858.
RESULT	Local risings were crushed one by one.
LIMITS	• Revolt over by mid-1858; Queen's Proclamation 1 Nov 1858.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Kunwar Singh (Jagdishpur) vs Amar Singh.
UPSC ASKED	• Frequent in leader–place matching.
EXAM HOOK	Kunwar Singh = Jagdishpur (Arrah); died, not hanged.

WHO CRUSHED WHAT

Nicholson–Delhi · **H**odson–Humayun's Tomb · **H**avelock–Kanpur · **C**ampbell–Lucknow relief · **R**ose–Jhansi. One more: **John Lawrence** held the Punjab.

Why it failed, who stayed loyal

Reasons for failure	Who stayed with the British
No common plan, programme or single leader. Bahadur Shah was only a symbol.	**Sikhs and Gurkhas**, and the **Madras and Bombay armies**
Limited to north and central India; Punjab, Bengal's big zamindars, Rajasthan and the south stayed away.	**Nizam of Hyderabad** (minister Salar Jung), **Scindia of Gwalior** (minister Dinkar Rao), Patiala, Jind
British superiority: arms, telegraph, railways, reinforcements from Britain.	**Jung Bahadur of Nepal** sent Gurkhas
Educated Indians and the new middle class did not support it.	Many princes saw the rebels as a threat to their own rule

Nature of the revolt: what historians said

Historian	View
John Seeley	A mere **sepoy mutiny**, "wholly unpatriotic and selfish"
V. D. Savarkar	The **first war of Indian independence** (book, 1909)
R. C. Majumdar	"Neither first, nor national, nor a war of independence"
S. N. Sen	Began as a fight for religion and ended as a war of independence
S. B. Chaudhuri	A **civil rebellion**: peasants, artisans, zamindars and taluqdars joined in north India
Marxist writers	A peasant uprising and last stand of feudal classes

REMEMBER

It began as a sepoy mutiny but became a **civil rebellion in Awadh, Bihar and western UP**: moneylenders, courts and revenue records were attacked. So "confined to the army" is wrong. The rebels had **no** coordinated plan, though Bahadur Shah was the nominal head.

After 1857: what changed

Change	Details
Government of India Act, 1858 (2 Aug)	Company rule ended; power to the **Crown**. Board of Control and Court of Directors abolished. A **Secretary of State for India** (a Cabinet minister) with a **15-member Council of India**; no Indians on it. Governor-General became **Viceroy**. **Canning** was the first Viceroy.
Queen's Proclamation 1 Nov 1858, Allahabad, read by Canning	**Promised**: no more annexations, respect for the rights and honour of princes, religious non-interference, impartial admission to services regardless of race or creed (subject to qualification). **Not promised**: elected legislatures.
Army	**Peel Commission** (appointed 1858, reported 1859). More European troops (about 1 European to 2 Indians in the Bengal Army; 2 to 5 in Madras and Bombay), **artillery kept in European hands**. Recruits shifted to Sikhs, Gurkhas and Punjabis (the "martial races") and regiments mixed by caste and region.
Princely states	Annexation given up. Princes got **adoption sanads**, because they had acted as "breakwaters" in the storm.
Indian Councils Act, 1861	Viceroy's Legislative Council to include non-official members, **nominated** (a few Indians). **No elections**; limited elections came in 1892.
Social attitude	Racial bitterness; a conservative turn: the British now avoided interfering with Indian religion and social customs.
Land	Awadh taluqdars loyal to Britain had their estates restored.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 4

1. Date of Mangal Pandey's attack? (29 March 1857, Barrackpore)
2. Who was proclaimed emperor at Delhi? (Bahadur Shah II)
3. Which general took Jhansi? (Hugh Rose)
4. What replaced the Company's rule? (Crown; GoI Act 1858)
5. What did the Proclamation not promise? (Elected legislatures)

Compare and contrast tables

Revolts, causes and what they led to

Revolt	Cause	Leader	Result
Sanyasi	Pilgrim tax; famine	Majnu Shah	Anandamath
Kol	Land taken by outsiders	Buddhu Bhagat	South West Frontier Agency, 1833
Santhal	Moneylenders; zamindars	Sido and Kanhu	Santhal Parganas
Munda	Land and forced labour	Birsa Munda	Chotanagpur Tenancy Act, 1908
Indigo	Tinkathia system	Biswas brothers	Indigo Commission 1860
Pabna	Rent rise	Ishan Chandra Roy	Bengal Tenancy Act 1885
Deccan	Moneylenders	Peasants of Supa	Relief Act 1879
Revolt 1857	Greased cartridges; annexation	Zafar, Nana Sahib	Act for Better Government of India 1858

Tribal and non-tribal revolts

Type	Examples	Aim
Tribal	Kol, Santhal, Munda, Khasi, Khond, Bhil	Protect land and customs
Peasant	Indigo, Pabna, Deccan, Mappila	Rent and debt relief

Type	Examples	Aim
Religious-agrarian	Titu Mir, Faraizi, Wahabi, Kuka	Purity and resistance
Civil and army	Vellore, Poligars, Paika, Kittur	Restore old power

Previous-year questions on this topic (as traced)

Year	Question and answer
2018	Neel Darpan placed in an order-of-events question.
2014	Birsa Munda in a tribal movements question.
Often	Leader–place matching for 1857 (Nana Sahib, Hazrat Mahal, Kunwar Singh, Rani of Jhansi).
Often	Wahabi (Syed Ahmad of Rae Bareli) swapped with Aligarh founder (Syed Ahmad Khan).

Few direct Prelims stems on minor revolts have been traced; most appear in matching lists.

8. Last-minute sheet

Pairs that are asked again and again

Leader	Movement or place
Sido, Kanhu	Santhal Hul (Rajmahal)
Birsa Munda	Ulgulan (Chotanagpur)
Buddho Bhagat	Kol
Tirot Singh	Khasi
Chakra Bisoi	Khond
Jagabandhu	Paika (Khurda)
Chittur Singh	Ramosi
Alluri Sitarama Raju	Rampa 1922
Titu Mir	Barasat, bamboo fort
Shariatullah, Dudu Miyan	Faraizi (Faridpur)

Leader	Movement or place
Ram Singh	Kuka (Namdhari)
Ishan Chandra Roy	Pabna
Digambar Biswas	Indigo (Nadia)
Nana Sahib	Kanpur
Hazrat Mahal	Lucknow
Kunwar Singh	Jagdishpur (Arrah)
Khan Bahadur Khan	Bareilly
Maulvi Ahmadullah	Faizabad
Rao Tula Ram	Rewari
Surendra Sai	Sambalpur
Maniram Dewan	Assam
Bakht Khan	Delhi (from Bareilly)

Date drill

Year	Event
1799	Kattabomman hanged
1806	Vellore Mutiny
1817	Paika revolt
1824	Kittur
1831	Titu Mir; Syed Ahmad killed at Balakot; Kol revolt begins
1855–56	Santhal Hul
1856	Awadh annexed; Enfield rifle; General Service Enlistment Act
1857	29 Mar Pandey; 10 May Meerut; 20 Sept Delhi falls; Nov Lucknow relieved
1858	April Jhansi; June Rani dies; 2 Aug GoI Act; 1 Nov Proclamation
1859	Tantia Tope hanged
1859–60	Indigo revolt; 1860 Indigo Commission
1861	Indian Councils Act

Year	Event
1873	Pabna
1875	Deccan riots; 1879 Relief Act
1899–1900	Munda Ulgulan; 1908 Tenancy Act

TEN WRONG STATEMENTS UPSC LIKES TO PUT IN OPTIONS

- Santhal revolt led by Birsa. (No: Sido and Kanhu.)
- Birsa was hanged. (No: cholera in jail.)
- Deccan riots were against zamindars. (No: moneylenders.)
- Pabna was against British rule. (No.)
- Indigo started in Pabna. (No: Nadia.)
- Faraizi started by Titu Mir. (No: Shariatullah.)
- Velu Thampi was Dewan of Mysore. (No: Travancore.)
- Colin Campbell captured Jhansi. (No: Hugh Rose.)
- Bahadur Shah was hanged. (No: Rangoon.) Kunwar Singh was hanged. (No.)
- Awadh was annexed under Lapse. (No: misrule.)

Sources: Spectrum, *A Brief History of Modern India* (Civil Rebellions and Tribal Uprisings; Peasant Movements; Revolt of 1857); Bipan Chandra, *India's Struggle for Independence*; M. Laxmikanth, *Indian Polity*, Ch. 1; Vajiram and Ravi, PW OnlyIAS, GKToday and Rau's IAS notes; UPSC Prelims 2018 and 2020 papers. Written in my own words for study. Map outline: Datameet composite India boundary, simplified; pins are approximate. Minor dates and names (Bhil, Pagal Panthi, Mappila leaders) vary between books; use the book's version if a question asks.